

The Pair Is Not the Object

Culture-Loaded Pairing in Cannabis, Psychosis, and AI Discourse

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Boundary: method paper, not medical advice, not a diagnostic instrument, not a denial of episodes, substances, technology effects, or clinical care needs

Source base: internal corpus drafts plus cited outside literature

Abstract

Some public questions arrive as pairs. A user asks for “cannabis and psychosis” or “AI and psychosis.” A model may then treat the pair as the object. That is the failure addressed here. A pair is a queue, not a claim.

This paper names **culture-loaded pairing**: a recurrent routing error in which two terms appear together often enough in media, policy, clinical, or platform discourse that the combined phrase starts to behave like a single thing. The fused phrase can steer explanation before exposure, timing, route, user role, evidence type, and counter-route have been named. In drug discourse, the old pair is cannabis and psychosis. In platform discourse, the newer pair is AI and psychosis. Both pairs can point to real cases and real study objects. Neither pair should be allowed to become the object by default.

The repair is **DEPAIR**: split the terms, give each term its own H0, then build a relation only from named routes. For cannabis and psychosis, this means separating plant, product, THC/CBD balance, dose pattern, age, frequency, co-use, social context, genetic liability, sleep, service contact, and measurement route. For AI and psychosis, it means separating model behavior, sycophancy, long context, isolation, sleep loss, substance state, prior clinical state, deification, meaning feedback, intervention failure, and case outcome. The paper gives a route sheet, a language-model protocol, and a transfer demo from cannabis discourse to AI discourse.

The result is not a softer verdict. It is a harder object gate. Reports may be real. Associations may be real. Case routes may be real. The pair is still not the object.

1. Core claim

The working claim is small:

PAIR != OBJECT
ASSOCIATION != OBJECT
USER_LIST != RELATION
A PAIRED QUESTION IS A QUEUE, NOT A CLAIM

A phrase such as “cannabis and psychosis” can mean several things:

tell me what each word means
tell me about the study literature
tell me about public messaging
tell me about a clinical conversation
tell me about policy language
tell me about a case
tell me about causation

A system that answers the pair as a single object has already moved too far. It has accepted a route before the route was earned.

This paper does not say that cannabis is irrelevant to psychosis-related outcomes. It does not say that AI systems cannot enter an episode, shape content, amplify conviction, or fail to interrupt escalation. It says the fused pair does not get first custody.

2. The failure mode

Culture-loaded pairing has this form:

term A appears often with term B
the pair becomes familiar
familiarity becomes a route
the route becomes a verdict
the verdict acts like evidence

The model then speaks from the fused object:

cannabis-and-psychosis
AI-and-psychosis
drugs-and-madness
chatbots-and-delusions

That shortcut produces several object errors.

First, it can answer a list as if it were a relation. Second, it can answer a relation as if it were cause. Third, it can treat a political or media pairing as if it were a measurement unit. Fourth, it can import public fear language into a clinical or scientific frame. Fifth, it can erase routes that would change the answer.

The earlier repair “association is not causation” arrives after the first loss. The model has already accepted the association as the object. The stronger repair is earlier:

ASSOC != OBJ
CULTURAL_ASSOC != SCI_OBJECT
DEPAIR BEFORE CAUSE

3. Two association types

The word association hides two objects.

STATISTICAL_ASSOCIATION:

a measured relation in data

CULTURAL_ASSOCIATION:

a public habit of fusing two terms

The statistical association can be examined through cohorts, case-control studies, dose patterns, genetic methods, service data, case reports, mechanistic work, and competing route analysis. It can support bounded statements.

The cultural association is a circulation pattern. It may come from policy, media, stigma, professional shorthand, advocacy, platform fear, moral language, or older templates such as “drugs produce madness.” It can be studied, but it cannot replace the study object.

A system needs both distinctions at once:

do not deny statistical association

do not inherit cultural fusion

4. DEPAIR protocol

DEPAIR is the route repair.

D: divide the terms

E: establish each local object

P: place H0 on each object and on the relation

A: audit routes

I: index source type

R: return only the relation that survived

For any paired question, the assistant should build three cards.

OBJECT_A:

what is being named?

what variants matter?

what state variables matter?

OBJECT_B:

what is being named?

what variants matter?

what state variables matter?

RELATION:

what relation is being asked?

association, mechanism, trigger, content, service route, policy route, or advice route?

The relation card is not allowed to borrow authority from the pair. It must pay with source type, route, and claim size.

5. Worked case: cannabis and psychosis

A DEPAIR reading starts with separation.

CANNABIS_OBJECT:

plant, product, THC, CBD, potency, route, frequency, age at first use,
duration, co-use, withdrawal, reintroduction, market route

PSYCHOSIS_OBJECT:

symptom pattern, episode timing, diagnosis route, service contact,
family history, sleep, stress, trauma, social defeat, stimulant exposure,
mood state, substance-induced state, measurement instrument

RELATION_OBJECT:

statistical association, dose pattern, genetic liability,
reverse direction, shared liability, service detection,
self-medication, policy frame, clinical intervention question

The literature supports bounded statements. High-frequency use, early initiation, high-potency products, and vulnerability markers appear repeatedly in the cannabis-schizophrenia and cannabis-psychosis literature [1-7]. Mendelian randomization and genetically informed studies complicate any one-line verdict by raising shared-liability and direction questions [5-7]. This is exactly why route custody is needed.

The public pair is a different object. The phrase “cannabis and psychosis” may carry drug-war residue, stigma, deterrence messaging, service-capture language, or a moral sorting habit. That public object can be measured as discourse, not smuggled in as biology.

The method output should look like this:

Cannabis is one object.

Psychosis is one object.

Their relation is a third object.

Public fusion is a fourth object.

Do not let object four answer for objects one through three.

6. Worked transfer: AI and psychosis

The same failure can appear in AI discourse.

Recent case reports and viewpoints describe situations where chatbot interaction was part of delusional experience, manic psychosis, or new-onset AI-associated psychosis [8-10]. OpenAI also publicly described a 2025 model behavior issue in which a released model became more sycophantic and validating than intended [11]. Research on social sycophancy gives a wider language for face-preserving model behavior in ambiguous support contexts [12]. These sources justify study. They do not justify fusion.

A DEPAIR reading starts with separation.

AI_OBJECT:

model family, product surface, memory, context length, personalization,
sycophancy, refusal behavior, tool use, authority tone, repetition,

validation pattern, escalation pattern

PSYCHOSIS_OBJECT:

episode state, manic state, delusional content, sleep loss,
substance state, prior history, care contact, social isolation,
belief consolidation, distress, functional disruption

RELATION_OBJECT:

induction, amplification, corroboration, content supply,
failed interruption, dependency loop, care delay, documentation route,
platform design route, user-state route

The pair “AI and psychosis” should not become a culture object that answers itself. It should become a queue of route questions.

Did the system induce the episode?

Did it amplify a live belief?

Did it corroborate content already present?

Did it fail to interrupt?

Did it supply symbolic material?

Did it replace social contact?

Did it interact with sleep loss, substances, mania, or isolation?

Those are different objects. Combining them into one phrase loses the study.

7. Body-route floor

The body-route floor keeps language from floating above bodies.

The sensory-system source used in this corpus describes sensing as signal, collection, transduction, processing, and action [13]. The human physiology source describes homeostatic regulation through receptors, control centers, effectors, feedback, and interacting body systems [14]. These sources do not prove any cannabis or AI claim. They anchor a route principle:

words are not body state
public pair is not exposure
exposure is not mechanism
mechanism is not outcome
outcome is not policy

A paired phrase is a language event. A clinical episode is a body, context, service, and meaning event. A study association is a measurement event. Route medicine starts by refusing to collapse those events.

8. Model protocol

When asked for a paired topic, the model should not default to the familiar public paragraph. It should run the pair protocol.

```
PAIR_PROTOCOL={  
  split_terms;  
  say_each_object_briefly;
```

```

ask_or_infer_relation_type;
name_source_type;
name_route_variables;
preserve_H0;
return_claim_size;
}

```

For “cannabis and psychosis”:

There are two topics here and a possible relation.
 Cannabis varies by product, potency, route, timing, and pattern.
 Psychosis names symptoms and clinical categories with multiple routes.
 The research literature reports associations in some study designs,
 especially for frequent, early, and high-potency exposure patterns.
 That does not make the phrase itself a causal object.

For “AI and psychosis”:

There are two topics here and a possible relation.
 AI systems vary by model behavior, memory, context, personalization,
 and validation style.
 Psychosis-related episodes vary by timing, prior state, sleep, substances,
 mania, isolation, and support context.
 Some case reports place chatbots inside the episode field.
 That does not make the phrase itself a causal object.

9. Claim-size ladder

A pair can support different claim sizes.

SIZE_0: separate overview
 SIZE_1: public discourse pairing exists
 SIZE_2: statistical association appears in named studies
 SIZE_3: bounded route claim with named exposure and outcome
 SIZE_4: mechanism proposal with limits
 SIZE_5: intervention claim with comparator and tradeoffs
 SIZE_6: policy claim with ethics and least-intrusion burden

Most public pair talk jumps from size 1 to size 6. DEPAIR blocks the jump.

For cannabis, a size 3 statement might name high-frequency, high-potency, early exposure patterns and psychosis-related outcomes in specified study designs. For AI, a size 3 statement might name a chatbot validation loop during a documented episode. Neither supports a size 6 verdict without further work.

10. Anti-misuse controls

The method can be misused in two directions.

The first misuse is denial by subdivision: splitting the pair until no route is allowed to count. DEPAIR forbids that. If a route is observed, the route stays.

The second misuse is fusion by alarm: treating the loud pair as if it has already done the work. DEPAIR forbids that too. If a route is not observed, the pair cannot spend its familiarity as evidence.

The control rule is:

```
REAL_REPORTS_STAY
REAL_ASSOCIATIONS_STAY
FUSED_PAIR_DOES_NOT_RULE
```

11. What this paper adds

This paper adds four pieces.

First, it names culture-loaded pairing as an object-custody failure that occurs before causal over-reach.

Second, it separates statistical association from cultural association.

Third, it gives DEPAIR as a practical route method for AI systems, writers, and reviewers.

Fourth, it shows that cannabis-and-psychosis and AI-and-psychosis share a structural problem without becoming the same problem. One can transfer the method without transferring the verdict.

12. Conclusion

The pair is not the object.

A public pair can be a search cue, a study prompt, a media object, a policy object, or a user request. It is not automatically a scientific object. Cannabis gets its own H0. Psychosis gets its own H0. AI gets its own H0. The relation gets its own evidence card.

Keeper:

```
A paired question is a queue, not a claim.
Split the objects.
Build the relation.
Do not let culture choose the cause.
```

Source ledger

Internal source materials used for this v0.001 synthesis:

```
extra_extra_expanded/the_pair_is_not_the_object_AI_psychosis_culture_problem_v0_002.md
extra_extra_expanded/ai_psychosis_no_h0_no_culture_object_v0_001.md
extra_extra_expanded/status_contaminated_causality_route_medicine_v0_004-A.md
extra_extra_expanded/nightmare_on_llm_street_fredi_body_route_floor_v0_003.md
Human_Physiology.pdf
Sensory_Systems.pdf
```

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